Task Sheet No. 9:
REFLECTION AND CERTIFICATE OF PARTICIPATION IN NATIONAL SEMINARS OR CONFERENCES

INSTRUCTION:

As a pre-service teacher, you are tasked to participate in a national seminar, conference, webinar, or professional development activity relevant to education and your field of specialization. After the activity, prepare a written reflection discussing the key knowledge, skills, insights, and professional learnings you gained and how these can be applied to your future teaching practice. Attach a copy of your Certificate of Participation/Attendance as evidence of your participation. Your output should demonstrate how the experience contributed to your professional growth and understanding of current trends, issues, and practices in education.

RUBRIC FOR GRADING:

CRITERIA	EXCELLENT	PROFICIENT	DEVELOPING	BEGINNING
Knowledge and Insights Gained (25%)	Clearly and comprehensively explains the important knowledge, insights, and skills gained from the seminar/conference, with specific examples.	Clearly explains relevant knowledge, insights, and skills gained, with some supporting details.	Identifies some learning gained but provides limited explanation or supporting details.	Provides minimal or unclear discussion of what was learned.
Application to Future Career (25%)	Provides a clear, specific, and thoughtful explanation of how the learning will contribute to future teaching practice and professional growth.	Explains how the learning can contribute to future teaching practice, with reasonable examples.	Provides a general explanation of possible application with limited examples.	Provides little or no explanation of how the learning can be applied to a future career.
Depth of Reflection (25%)	Demonstrates deep personal reflection, critical thinking, and meaningful connections between the seminar and future professional practice.	Demonstrates thoughtful reflection and makes relevant connections to professional practice.	Demonstrates some reflection but connections are mostly general or descriptive.	Shows little evidence of reflection or critical thinking.
Completeness, Accuracy, and Presentation (25%)	Response is complete, accurate, well-organized, coherent, and professionally presented, addressing all required questions thoroughly.	Response is mostly complete, accurate, and well-organized, with minor omissions or presentation issues.	Response is partially complete or contains some inaccuracies, unclear ideas, or organizational issues.	Response is incomplete, inaccurate, poorly organized, or difficult to understand.

Activity: Write a short refection about a national seminars or conferences attended or participated. Indicate what you had learned and what do they contribute to your future career as teacher (limit your answer to one page only).

REFLECTION ESSAY
1. What knowledge, insights, and skills did you gain from the seminar or conference you attended? Discuss the key concepts, ideas, or practices that you found meaningful and relevant to your professional development.
Attending the professional training seminar entitled "Effective Classroom Management That Really Works," presented by Jasper Prior of iTTi Oaxaca, reshaped how I view classroom dynamics as a student teacher. Previously, I perceived classroom management as a disciplinary effort to enforce order and control students. However, the seminar emphasized that management is design—it is about proactively building an environment where appropriate behavior is explicitly taught, naturally facilitated, and consistently reinforced. A central takeaway was understanding the Spectrum of Disruption. The session broke disruptions into three key levels: • Low-Level Friction: Subtle issues such as pen-tapping, side-chatting, or smartphone distractions that gradually erode instructional focus. • Overt Interruption: Behaviors like blurting out without nomination or wandering across the room, which require immediate redirection. • Active Resistance: Direct refusal to participate or challenging instructions, which frequently signals underlying task frustration or a skill gap rather than mere defiance. I also gained practical skills in establishing the IES Antecedents & Consequences Framework. The presenter highlighted the necessity of explicitly teaching behavioral expectations using concrete, observable actions (e.g., *"Voices off and eyes on the speaker"* instead of ambiguous directives like *"Be ready"*). Additionally, I learned the 4:1 positive reinforcement ratio—delivering four specific affirmations for every redirection to sustain behavioral momentum—and a four-step de-escalation sequence: *Quiet Reminder*, *Choice/Redirection*, *Consequence (if needed)*, and *Reset to Learning*, paired with explicit replacement behaviors.
2. How do you think your learnings from the seminar or conference will contribute to your future career as a teacher? Explain how you can apply the knowledge, skills, and insights gained to your future teaching practice and professional growth.
As a pre-service teacher preparing for full classroom responsibility, these learnings provide a clear blueprint for my instructional practice. First, I will replace generic praise like "Good job" with precise, behavior-specific feedback (such as "You started the task immediately and organized your materials promptly—that keeps our class moving forward"). Because active engagement substantially lowers behavioral issues compared to passive listening, I will structure my lessons around hands-on, collaborative activities and minimize prolonged teacher talk.

Second, I will design and rehearse predictable classroom routines—covering how to transition between tasks, access learning materials, and request assistance during independent work—practicing them until they become second nature. When student friction arises, I will utilize the Calm Response Audit to regulate my own physical baseline (monitoring my breathing, maintaining an open stance, and keeping my vocal pitch steady) before intervening. Instead of getting drawn into power struggles, I will address off-task actions quietly, evaluate the antecedent causes behind the resistance, and provide alternative replacement behaviors.

For my ongoing professional development, I will set aside time each week to reflect on transition routines and consult with my mentor teacher to identify and resolve any "design friction" within my lesson plans.

Certificate of attendance or participation

